Look Out For the Vest

Topic: Introducing the New-Hire Safety Vest

1. OPEN (30 seconds) - SET THE SCENE

Say: "Starting now, you will see some people wearing hi-vis vests. Let's talk about what that means and why we are doing it."

2. THE POINT (1-2 min)

WHAT THE VEST MEANS

"If you see a vest, you are seeing someone who is new and still learning. They need your eyes and your guidance. The vest is not a punishment - it is a signal to the whole crew to look out for that person."

WHY WE ARE DOING THIS

Our data shows most incidents happen in the first few months. New people do not know the hazards yet, and they might not feel comfortable asking. The vest tells everyone "help this person," so they are not navigating the floor alone.

3. THE ASK (1-2 min) - WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

Three things every crew member should do:

1. WATCH OUT for anyone in a vest - if they look unsure or are about to do something risky, step in.
2. GUIDE them - show them, explain the "why," not just the "what." (Think: how would you want to be taught your first week?)
3. FLAG anything they miss - quietly, kindly. We all want them to go home safe.

AND one thing to NOT do:

Do not make them feel bad for not knowing. Everyone was new once. The only bad question is the one not asked.

4. DISCUSSION (2 min) - ASK THE CREW

"Can you remember a time you were new and someone looked out for you on the floor? What did they do?"

"If you saw someone in a vest about to reach into a machine, what would you do?"

5. CLOSE (30 seconds)

"Be the person you wish you had on your first day. When you see the vest, that is your cue to be their safety net. Thanks everyone."

SUPERVISOR NOTES

Keep it conversational, not a lecture. Let people answer the questions. The goal is that everyone leaves knowing their role in protecting new hires. If a specific new-hire situation comes up, acknowledge it - that is the real message.